

Directions for questions 1 to 3: The following questions have a paragraph from which the **last** sentence has been omitted. From the given options, choose the one that completes the paragraph in the most appropriate way.

Few countries in the world exist where secularism is more bitterly contested and perhaps even fewer countries than India where the term has been persistently misused and abused. No other term in India has been continuously battered and evacuated of meaning or significance. The cacophony that surrounds secularism may well be the price that secularism has to pay for becoming an integral part of our country's public and political discourse. A couple of decades ago, Indian secularism was unfairly charged by its opponents for being anti-religious. It was subsequently labelled as a pro-minority doctrine. _____.

☐ a) Under modern conditions, the practice of patronising all existing religions by the state developed into a defence of religious pluralism.

☒ b) The state has to respect all religions and treat them non-preferentially as respecting religions often entails the necessity of the state to keep off all religions. (Your answer - ✕)

☐ c) India's constitutional secularism requires that the Indian state be neither wholly respectful nor disrespectful to religions.

☐ d) In recent times, we have been advised to choose between secularism and development, as if secularism was an anti-development ideology. (Correct Answer - ✓)

Solution:

The term 'secularism' is being persistently misused and abused in India. Instead of respecting the best in religious groups, political parties hobnob with those least deserving of respect.

Read the two sentences preceding the blank – a sequential description of the course of events. Two decades ago, Indian secularism was unfairly charged for being anti-religious. It was subsequently labelled as a pro-minority doctrine. Option (D), which tells about what's happening in recent times, perfectly fits the blank. Options (A) and (B) speak about religions, whereas continuation of the discussion on secularism is what's needed for relevance. Option (C) diverts to constitutional secularism.

Choice (D)

Directions for questions 1 to 3: The following questions have a paragraph from which the **last** sentence has been omitted. From the given options, choose the one that completes the paragraph in the most appropriate way.

“I’d like to die on Mars. Just not on impact.” Elon Musk has never been shy about his reasons for founding SpaceX, a rocketry firm that has become the flag-carrier for a buccaneering “New Space” industry. Although two recent rocket explosions have dented its halo, its launch prices are among the lowest in the world. It has pioneered the technology of returning expended rocket stages to Earth for later reuse, landing them back on special pads or on ocean-going barges, which should cut costs still further. _____.

- ☐ a) Mr Musk has repeatedly said that he believes human beings must learn how to live on places other than Earth, as an insurance policy against a planet-wrecking disaster.
- ☒ b) As a result, it has a thick book of orders from private firms and the American government to fly satellites into orbit and cargo – and, eventually astronauts – to the International Space Station. (Your answer - ✓)
- ☐ c) A permanent colony on Mars is undeniably a grand ambition, but Mr. Musk’s ideas about how to begin, and how to build the necessary infrastructure to get people there, are worth pondering.
- ☐ d) Besides the sense of prestige and derring-do, the reason Mars makes an attractive target is that it is, Earth aside, the friendliest world in the neighbourhood.

Solution:

The passage is about interplanetary settlement and Elon Musk’s vision of a human colony on Mars.

SpaceX, a rocketry firm founded by Musk, has become the flag-carrier for a bold “New Space” industry. Its launch prices are quite low. Most significantly, the firm has pioneered the technology of returning expended rocket stages to Earth for subsequent reuse. This evoked interest in the US government as well as several private organisations that were quick to place their orders with SpaceX. Thus, option (B) aptly fits the blank. The remaining options do not get linked to the preceding sentence.

Choice (B)

Directions for questions 1 to 3: The following questions have a paragraph from which the **last** sentence has been omitted. From the given options, choose the one that completes the paragraph in the most appropriate way.

To a layman, the phrase “Internet of Things” (IOT) probably conjures up a half-fantastic future in which refrigerators monitor their own contents and send orders direct to the grocer when the butter is running out, while tired commuters order baths to be drawn automatically using their smartphones as they approach their houses in their self-driving cars. Actually, though, a version of the IOT is already here. Wi-Fi hubs, smart televisions, digital video-recorders and the like are all part of a network of devices run by microprocessors that, just as much as desktop, laptop and tablet computers, form part of the internet – but with one crucial distinction. Unlike things immediately recognisable as computers, these devices are often designed with poor security, or even none at all. _____

- ☒ a) They are wide open to malicious hackers who might wish to misuse them. (Your answer - ✓)
- ☐ b) Attacks may be carried out by organised criminals to hold a firm to ransom.
- ☐ c) One favourite trick of hackers is the distributed denial of service attack.
- ☐ d) Attacks may be carried out by cyber-savvy countries, as a tool of low-level warfare – or, as in the case of one of the latest attacks, for revenge.

Solution:

The internet of things is gradually becoming an internet of stings. Devices run by microprocessors are often designed with poor security, or even zero security. If that's so, the sentence following it should speak about the susceptibility. Option (A) does it, and is the apt answer. The rest of the options speak about the various types of cyber attacks, which cannot fill the blank appropriately.

Choice (A)

Directions for questions 4 to 8: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. Given the shape and location of these particles, they argue, it could only derive from emissions from aviation fuel and they pose a problem because these black carbon particles can linger long enough to provide a fertile ground for other chemical reactions that can deplete the ozone layer.
2. However, a group of scientists — say they now have evidence of such particles existing up to 18km into the stratosphere and there are about 10,000 of them in every cubic centimeter.
3. Though airborne, black carbon is known to dissipate and settle down in a few months under the influence of rain and wind and is unlikely to travel upward of 4 km.
4. It may also be depleting the ozone layer, according to a study by climate researchers from multiple institutions in the country.
5. Aeroplanes may be ejecting significant amounts of black carbon — a pollutant known to aggravate breathing disorders, upset the monsoon and quicken glacier melt.

Solution:

The paragraph is about the aeroplanes adding to our woe of atmospheric pollution. The starter would be choice 5, which talks about aeroplanes and the emission of black carbon which can upset monsoons, cause breathing problems and make glaciers melt. Choice 4 follows, mentioning about a recent study which reports that this black carbon may also be depleting the ozone layer. Choice 3 follows with the air borne carbon dissipating and settling down under the influence of rain. Choice 2 is next with more depressing news that scientists are having proof that these particles exist at 10000 per every cubic centimeter. Choice 1 sums up from the shape and location of these particles it could be only from aero-emissions.

Ans : (54321)

Directions for questions 4 to 8: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. A book is a series of words on a page or a screen, a string of words that forms ideas and images, and it's up to each individual reader what he or she does with those ideas and images.
2. As a society claiming to have democratic ideals, we have to prosecute the perpetrators of violence and not ban the book or film used as an excuse for that violence.
3. If someone wants to generate actual violence on the basis of a book or a film, it's a crime and there is no justification for it.
4. If some are hurt by reading a book, then, well, they are hurt; they can write another text to counter the hurtful book.
5. If we as a nation start to applaud and bolster people who burn effigies of writers and artists, we are done for.

Solution:

The paragraph is about books and their influence on the readers. It starts with choice 1 which says that how a reader perceives a book is up to him. Choice 4 follows saying that if someone is hurt by a book then it is a simple fact that he is hurt and can write his comments about the book. Choice 3 is next saying that if someone generates violence on the basis of a book there is no justification for it. Choice 2 is next stating that as a democratic society we have to punish the perpetrators of violence and not ban the book. Choice 5 sums up saying that it is totally wrong to encourage people to burn the effigies of writers and artists.

Ans : (14325)

Directions for questions 4 to 8: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. Algorithm was a part of mathematics and technology and it had hardly revealed its stranglehold on the information ecology.
2. Artificial intelligence was a footnote.
3. Fake news, doctored videos, unsubstantiated inflammatory news content that further divide and polarize our society are increasing by the day.
4. However, the march of technology with its myriad participatory platforms, aided by people's desire to believe what they want to believe, has made the task of a news ombudsman difficult.
5. Albert Einstein's wry remark, "Artificial intelligence is no match for natural stupidity," was invoked sometimes to prove a point.

Solution:

The paragraph is about inflammatory news and its ill-effects on society and how a reader's editor has the daunting task of sifting the good and the bad news and project the right picture. The wry starter would be choice 1 talking about algorithms and how very little is known about its strong hold on information ecology. Choice 2 follows with a tongue-in-cheek comment that in this scenario artificial intelligence is just a foot note. Choice 5 talks about Einstein's comment that artificial intelligence can never be a substitute for natural stupidity. Choice 4 laments that social networking and participatory platforms with people forming their own opinions (which are sometimes not right) has made the task of the news ombudsman very difficult. Choice 3 sums up with fake news, doctored videos and inflammatory news that further contaminate the society.

Ans : (12543)

Directions for questions 4 to 8: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. It has been a truly exciting journey — writing 250 columns and addressing nearly 5,000 queries from concerned readers.
2. It poses the same intractable challenges in understanding as of that in the relationship between brain and mind.
3. There was not a single query that did not force me to look at the fundamentals of the narrative in the public sphere.
4. I was driven to literature, philosophy, law, ethics and an entire oeuvre of theories on journalism during the past five years to earnestly address the questions from readers, without fear or favor.
5. The defining element of this journey has been the chance to reflect on the craft of journalism and its intrinsic value as a public good.

Solution:

The paragraph talks about the task of an editor in writing columns and addressing questions from the readers. The starter would be choice 1 which talks about the editor's exciting journey in writing 250 columns and addressing 5000 queries from readers. Next is choice 5 talking about how journalism can be used for the betterment of society. Choice 3 follows with how the editor had to deeply reflect on the narrative for each and every question from the reader. Choice 4 comes next talking about the author referring to various texts in literature, philosophy, law, ethics etc., to answer the readers' queries without fear or favor. Choice 2 sums up with the author admitting that it was a challenging job which needed perfect synchronization of the brain and mind
Ans : (15342)

Directions for questions 4 to 8: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

- ^{1.} The Indian rupee has turned out to be one of the best-performing currencies in the world with a gain of well over 6% against the U.S. dollar this year to date.
- ^{2.} But strong capital inflow has managed to turn the tide.
- ^{3.} Around the beginning of 2017, analysts were bearish on the rupee, predicting that it would breach the 70-mark by the end of the year.
- ^{4.} In fact, the currency hit a two-year high of 63.60 supported by strong inflows of foreign capital.
- ^{5.} In addition, foreign direct investment in India doubled compared to last year

Solution:

The paragraph talks about the Indian rupee being one of the best currencies in the world. The starter is choice 1 talking about this performance with a 6 percent gain against the US dollar. Choice 4 follows saying that the rupee had hit a two-year high with good foreign capital inflow. Choice 3 is next with the finance gurus predicting a bearish trend for the rupee. Choice 2 is next with the strong capital inflows contradicting this prediction. Choice 5 sums up saying that the FDI has doubled in comparison to the previous year.

Ans : (14325)

1. Japan has gone through a lot as a country – any number of tsunamis and earthquakes, and the unfortunate American expeditions during the Second World War, to name a few.
2. Finally, the most enlightening feature of the Japanese people, and something that is in stark contrast to how we Indians are known to work, is the punctuality with which they approach everything they do.
3. When this amazing reverence is added to their insanely polite demeanor, it leaves everyone they meet with a smile on their face and a general feeling of satisfaction!
4. But the Japanese people indeed picked themselves up bravely, dusted themselves up, and worked together for a brighter future.
5. In the land that is said to be graced by the first sun rays of the new day, principle and values have been honored and lived for over the centuries – and maybe that's why they've become the economy of resilience and innovation that they are today.

Solution:

The paragraph is about Japan, that little nation which always bounces back in spite of calamities. The starter would be choice 1 talking about the natural and man-made disasters that have ravaged Japan. Next would be choice 4 recalling how Japan has always fought back bravely and moved on to toil for a brighter future. Choice 5 is next talking about this land of the rising sun and how it has honored its principles and values. Choice 2 sums up with the most enlightening feature of the Japanese – their punctuality. 1452 is the right sequence of the sentences and choice 3, an amazing reverence, may be later in the passage.

Ans : (3)

Directions for questions 9 to 13: Each of the following questions presents 5 statements of which 4, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick a statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

- ^{1.} Philosophers starting from Socrates, who lived in the 5th century B.C., to Bertrand Russell of “Why I am not a Christian” fame, have fascinated me for a long time.
- ^{2.} For instance, when you write a short story or poem it can be re-arranged, re-written and edited until you are satisfied with the final version.
- ^{3.} Not only do they think differently, but also expose sophisms, spot fallacies and guide our reasoning.
- ^{4.} Philosophers spend many years, nay decades, honing their skills on thinking vertically or laterally.
- ^{5.} The only reason for my fascination is that all of them used to think differently, mostly on abstract subjects such as “What is the purpose of life?” or “What is justice?” or “Why are we here?”

Solution:

The paragraph is about philosophers and the author's fascination for them. Choice 1 is the starter talking about Socrates and Bertrand Russell. Choice 5 is next explaining why the author is fascinated by them. Choice 3 follows saying that philosophers think differently and also expose deceits and fallacies. Choice 4 sums up saying that philosophers spend decades honing up their thinking skills. 1, 5, 3, 4 is the right sequence of the sentences and choice 2 talking about short stories and poems may be later in the passage.

Ans : (2)

Directions for questions 9 to 13: Each of the following questions presents 5 statements of which 4, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick a statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

- ^{1.} Scientists have for the first time managed to edit genes in a human embryo to repair a genetic mutation, fueling hopes that such procedures may one day be available outside laboratory conditions.
- ^{2.} The cardiac disease causes sudden death in otherwise healthy young athletes and affects about one in 500 people overall.
- ^{3.} In results announced in *Nature* this week, scientists fixed a mutation that thickens the heart muscle, a condition called hypertrophic cardiomyopathy.
- ^{4.} The embryos were produced with the clear intention of using them solely for research and not for implanting them in women.
- ^{5.} It is caused by a mutation in a particular gene and a child will suffer from the condition even if it inherits only one copy of the mutated gene.

Solution:

The passage is about a breakthrough in genetics for a condition called hypertrophic cardiomyopathy. The starter is choice 1 which talks about this feat where scientists could edit genes in a human embryo to repair a genetic mutation. Choice 3 follows talking about this medical condition which was fixed. Choice 2 follows talking about how this cardiac disease caused sudden deaths in healthy people. Choice 5 sums up explaining how this cardiac disease occurs. 1, 3, 2, 5 is the right sequence of sentences and choice 4 talking about embryos for research may be later in the passage.

Ans : (4)

Directions for questions 9 to 13: Each of the following questions presents 5 statements of which 4, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick a statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

1. The U.S. Food and Drug Administration has struck panic among tobacco companies by announcing a comprehensive proposal to reduce the amount of nicotine in cigarettes to non-addictive levels.
2. This is aimed at striking at the root of the problem of smokers getting addicted, and being unable to quit the habit.
3. While they may pull out all the stops to subvert or dilute tobacco control measures, the government should remain resolute in not losing the gains made in the last few years.
4. Nicotine does not directly cause cancers and other diseases that kill people, but is extremely addictive.
5. While the proposal is at an early stage and it may take a while before it gets implemented, if at all, it outlines a powerful strategy.

Solution:

The paragraph is about the proposal of the US Food and Drug Administration to reduce the amount of nicotine in cigarettes. Choice 1 is the starter talking about this proposal. Choice 2 is next talking about the purpose of this proposal. Choice 4 follows saying that while nicotine does not directly cause cancer and other diseases it is highly addictive. Choice 5 sums up saying that if and when this proposal is implemented it will be a powerful strategy. 1, 2, 4, 5 is the right sequence of sentences while choice 3 talking about the opposition for this proposal may be later in the passage.

Ans : (3)

- ^{1.} Among the most affordable transport systems in the world, India's railway network carries millions of people every day, linking the remotest destinations.
- ^{2.} It is unlikely, therefore, that the recently unveiled catering policy will make a big difference unless the process of identifying caterers, fixing prices, and ensuring quality control is transparent and is monitored by external auditors.
- ^{3.} Although the rot in passenger services has been repeatedly identified, it has only grown worse.
- ^{4.} The report of the Comptroller and Auditor General on catering services for the year ended March 2016 provides further evidence that little has changed in the system: like food unsuitable for human consumption and contaminated and recycled items.
- ^{5.} Yet, in a fast-growing country with rising ambitions, the system is caught in a time warp, unable to scale up its services to global standards and hobbled by inefficient management.

Solution:

The paragraph is about Indian railways and the different ways to improve its services. The starter would be choice 1, which talks about the Indian railways carrying millions of people to their destinations everyday, is the opening sentence. Choice 5 is next lamenting about the lack of proper services and inefficient management. Choice 3 follows stating that though the lacunae in services have been identified they have not been plugged. Choice 4 is last talking about the report of the Comptroller and Auditor General on catering services on the quality of food provided by the Indian railways. 1, 5, 3, 4 is the logical sequence of sentences and choice 2 talking about the catering policy may be later in the passage.

Ans : (2)

Directions for questions 14 and 15: Four alternative summaries are given below each text.

Choose the option that best captures the essence of the text and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

Identity politics on the left was at first about large classes of people – African-Americans, women, - seeking to redress major historical wrongs by mobilizing and then working through our political institutions to secure their rights. But by the 1980s it had given way to a pseudo-politics of self-regard and increasingly narrow and exclusionary self-definition that is now cultivated in our colleges and universities. The main result has been to turn young people back onto themselves, rather than turning them outward toward the wider world they share with others. It has left them unprepared to think about the common good in non-identity terms and what must be done practically to secure it – especially the hard and unglamorous task of persuading people very different from themselves to join a common effect. Every advance of liberal *identity* consciousness has marked a retreat of effective liberal *political* consciousness.

1. Identity politics, which was for the correction of historical wrongs, has evolved to accommodate effective liberal political consciousness.
2. The spirit of identity politics has remained fundamentally same, though the goal has shifted to a better one in due course of time.
3. Identity politics, which was once aimed at correcting historical wrongs, has started making the young self-centered, unfortunately to the detriment of common good.
4. The changing socio political milieu has its toll on the source and goal of identity politics.

Solution:

The paragraph says that in the past, identity politics was for correcting historical wrongs, but now it has given way to 'pseudo-politics' and 'exclusionary self-definition'. The result is the 'retreat of effective liberal political consciousness'. All this implies that the people with identity politics have become 'selfish' and do not look for 'common good'. This sense is given by Option 3, which is the best option.

Option 1: Incorrect because the current identity politics does not support effective liberal political consciousness.

Option 2: Incorrect because the goal has shifted to a 'worse' one of self-interest.

Option 3: Correct as per the reasons given above.

Option 4: Incorrect because the reason for the change in identity politics is not mentioned in the passage.

Thus, the best option is Option 3.

Ans : (3)

Directions for questions 14 and 15: Four alternative summaries are given below each text.

Choose the option that best captures the essence of the text and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

Recognition is famously a passage from ignorance to knowledge. It is not the same as comprehension, and it does not require an exchange of words: more often than not, we recognize mutely. The first syllable of the word *recognition* harks back to something prior, an already existing awareness—a moment of recognition occurs when a prior awareness flashes before us, effecting an instant change in our understanding of that which we behold. Yet this flash cannot appear spontaneously; it cannot disclose itself except in the presence of its lost other.

1. Recognition is different from knowledge, as the former adds new comprehension of things and the latter recapitulates past awareness.
2. The knowledge that results from recognition is not of the same kind of the discovery of something new: it arises, rather, from a renewed reckoning with a potentiality that lies within oneself.
3. The flash of recognition, though not spontaneous, is independent of existing knowledge.
4. The word *recognition* has different connotations in different contexts that it is used in.

Solution:

As per the paragraph, recognition 'harks back to something prior, an already existing awareness'. It 'cannot disclose itself except in the presence of its lost other'. This implies that we had some awareness in the past and it was lost. Now we 'recognize it'. This sense is given in very indirect terms in Option B, which is the best option.

Option 1: Incorrect because the former (recognition) does *not* add new awareness or comprehension. In fact, this option would have been correct if the words 'former' and 'latter' had been interchanged.

Option 2: Correct as per the reasons given above.

Option 3: Incorrect because recognition is 'not independent of existing knowledge'.

Option 4: Incorrect because the paragraph does not talk about different connotations of the word.

Thus, the best option is Option 2.

Ans : (2)